

Early Years

A child was born in Macedonia, Eastern Europe. She was born in 1910. Her name is Agnes. When she is 12, her life changes. Agnes hears the call of God. Agnes wants to serve God. Agnes wants to serve the poor.

Fact: Agnes has an older brother and sister.

Agnes is 18 years old. She wants to be a nun and work for the Catholic church. Agnes moves to Dublin, Ireland. She joins an order of Irish nuns. The order sends her to India.

Agnes takes her vows as a nun. She will become known as Mother Teresa.

Fact: She sails to India on December 1, 1928.

The Slums of Calcutta

Mother Teresa teaches school in Calcutta. The school is for girls. She teaches from 1931 to 1946. She helps many students to learn. She works hard as a teacher. She cares about her students.

Fact: Mother Teresa teaches at the Loreto Convent School.

Mother Teresa lives in a special home for Catholic nuns called a convent. On Sundays, she visits the poor. She visits hungry people. She visits sick people. She visits dying people. These people are the “poorest of the poor.”

Mother Teresa sees people who live on the street. They have no place to sleep. They have never slept on a bed. They go to sleep hungry. They sleep on the dirty streets of Calcutta.

Mother Teresa's Work

It is 1946. Mother Teresa hears the call of God again. God tells her to live with the poor. It is the call within the call. In 1948, Mother Teresa leaves the convent. Her life's work is about to begin.

Mother Teresa opens a school in the poor area of Calcutta called the slums. The school has no walls. The school has no books. The school has no blackboards. Mother Teresa uses a stick to write letters in the mud. The poor children learn to read and write.

Mother Teresa sees people die on the streets. They need to see doctors. They need medicine. But they have no money. Mother Teresa wants to care for the poor and sick. She wants to learn basic medicine.

Mother Teresa learns basic medicine. She learns how to give needles. She learns how to treat wounds. She learns how to treat diseases. Now she can help sick people.

Fact: Mother Teresa learns medicine in Patna, India in 1948.

People hear about Mother Teresa's work. The students she used to teach help her. The students learn how to help the poor. They learn how to talk to the poor.

Quote: It is not "how much we give, but how much love we put in the giving." — Mother Teresa

The Missionaries of Charity

In 1950, Mother Teresa starts her own order in the church. It is called the Missionaries of Charity. Mother Teresa says people talk about "the poor but very few people talk to the poor." The nuns love and care for the poor.

The nuns take a vow of poverty. This means the nuns live like the poor. The nuns dress like the poor. The nuns eat like the poor. The nuns choose to live this way.

Mother Teresa loves children. She wants to save the lives of unborn babies. She speaks against abortion. Mother Teresa says: "If a mother can kill her own child, what is there to stop us from killing ourselves or one another? Nothing."

Mother Teresa has a special place in her heart for people with a special disease who are called lepers. She opens many clinics for lepers. The nuns give them food. The nuns give them clothes. The nuns give them medicine. The nuns treat the lepers with dignity.

Fact: Many people are afraid of lepers. Mother Teresa teaches people not to be afraid.

Mother Teresa and the nuns work with the poorest of the poor. No one else will help these people. The nuns give food to the hungry. They give shelter to the homeless. Mother Teresa says, "the poor must know that we love them."

The Order Grows

In 1960, Mother Teresa's order starts to grow. The order opens a home for the dying. The order opens a home for children. The order opens many homes across India. Now the poorest of the poor have a home.

Today, the Missionaries of Charity has homes in more than 130 countries. There are homes for sick people. The nuns treat about 4 million sick people each year. There are homes for children. The nuns care for 7,000 children each year.

Mother Teresa Becomes Famous

Mother Teresa wins the Nobel Peace Prize in 1979. People plan a dinner for her. It will cost \$7,000. Mother Teresa cancels the dinner. She takes the \$7,000. She gives the money to the poor. The money will feed 400 people for a year.

Fact: Pope John XXIII gives Mother Teresa a peace prize in 1971.

Mother Teresa dies on September 5, 1997. She is 87 years old. People from all over the world go to her funeral. The leader of France learns about her death. He says, “there is less love” and “less light in the world.”

Many people think Mother Teresa is a saint. It takes a long time for the Catholic Church to give a person this title. A saint is a special person who has lived a holy life. Some day Mother Teresa will be a saint.

Mother Teresa has made the world a better place. She has spread love and peace all over the world. Mother Teresa has helped poor people all over the world. Mother Teresa is gone, but her work lives on.